

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-IV

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. There are THIRTEEN questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. Questions 1-5 contain two 10-mark parts. Questions 6-7 carry 10 marks each.
3. Questions 8-12 are 20-mark case studies; Question 13 is a 30-mark case study.
4. Use ethical concepts, stakeholder analysis, options, reasons and safeguards.

Q1. (a) "A system of morality which is based on relative emotional values is a mere illusion, a thoroughly vulgar conception which has nothing sound in it and nothing true." - Socrates. What does this quotation mean to you? (b) Discuss why a positive attitude, though necessary, is not a sufficient condition for ethical conduct in civil service. Illustrate with the concept of the attitude-behaviour gap.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q2. (a) "The Right to Information Act is not all about citizens' empowerment alone, it essentially redefines the concept of accountability." Discuss. (b) Distinguish between laws and rules. Discuss the role of ethics in formulating them.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q3. (a) Carl von Clausewitz once said, "War is a diplomacy by other means." Critically analyse the above statement in the present context of contemporary geo-political conflict. (b) An independent and empowered social audit mechanism is an absolute must in every sphere of public service, including judiciary, to ensure performance, accountability and ethical conduct. Elaborate.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q4. (a) "In law, a man is guilty when he violates the rights of others. In ethics, he is guilty if he only thinks of doing so." - Immanuel Kant. What does this quotation convey to you in the present context? (b) Distinguish transparency, disclosure, information sharing and accountability in public administration.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q5. (a) "The true rule, in determining to embrace, or reject any thing, is not whether it has any evil in it; but whether it has more evil than good...especially of governmental policy...our best judgment of the preponderance between them is continually demanded." - Abraham Lincoln. What does this quotation mean to you in the present context? (b) Distinguish Section 17A approval from Section 19 sanction under the Prevention of Corruption Act. Why does the distinction matter?

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q6. Compare the ethical significance of Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey without reducing either case to a hero story.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q7. Is it possible for emotional intelligence to help in overcoming a crisis of conscience without compromising the ethical stand that one may like to take? Critically examine.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q8. Rajesh, an administrative officer in a public-sector undertaking, is asked to procure stationery from a particular vendor. The total estimate exceeds his delegated limit, while splitting orders to avoid higher sanction is a common but rule-violating practice. What are his options, the ethical issues and the most appropriate course? Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q9. A humanitarian donor offers urgent climate-disaster assistance to an Indian Ocean island state but ties it to unrelated procurement preferences, exclusive access to strategic infrastructure and donor control over beneficiary data. Evaluate the

options and propose an ethical aid compact. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q10. An investigative journalist uncovers a stone-mining mafia involving corrupt police and civil officials and a politically connected media owner, while inducement and pressure are used to suppress publication. Evaluate the options, ethical dilemmas and appropriate response. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q11. A State plans to link welfare, health and land databases to detect fraud and publish a district dashboard. As the responsible secretary, design an ethical information-sharing and transparency framework. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q12. A public-sector quality officer discovers that a safety-critical product failed tests, but senior management orders clearance to avoid losses and threatens retaliation. Decide. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q13. Edward Snowden, a computer expert and former CIA systems administrator, released confidential Government documents to the press about the existence of Government surveillance programmes. According to many legal experts and the US Government, his actions violated the Espionage Act of 1917, which identified the leak of State secrets as an act of treason. Yet, despite the fact that he broke the law, Snowden argued that he had a moral obligation to act. He gave a justification for his "whistle blowing" by stating that he had a duty "to inform the public as to that which is done in their name and that which is done against them." According to Snowden, the Government's violation of privacy had to be exposed regardless of legality since more substantive issues of social action and public morality were involved here. Many agreed with Snowden. Few argued that he broke the law and compromised national security, for which he should be held accountable. Do you agree that Snowden's actions were ethically justified even if legally prohibited? Why or why not? Make an argument by weighing the competing values in this case.

[30 marks | 350 words]

END OF PAPER